

CATEGORY	Calculator for Firewalls Test - July 2003							
Developer	Grisoft	Micro World	F-Secure	Network Associates	Symantec	Panda Software	Trend Micro	Cat Computer Systems
Product Name	AVG 6.0	eScan Virus Control Ed.	F-Secure AntiVirus 2003	McAfee VirusScan 7	Norton AntiVirus 2003	Panda AntiVirus Titanium	PC-cillin 2003	Quick Heal X-GEN
Ease of Use (25%)	17.12	12.77	11.14	17.12	15.22	14.67	17.12	13.86
Configurable Features (20%)	6.67	5.00	1.67	17.50	11.67	3.33	11.67	8.33
Scanning (20%)	14.54	18.99	18.73	18.12	16.57	18.25	17.86	12.72
Scheduling (10%)	10.00	6.00	0.00	6.00	8.00	0.00	9.00	6.00
Updating (15%)	11.25	9.84	11.25	10.31	9.84	12.19	11.25	9.38
Resource Utilisation (10%)	10.00	8.00	2.00	6.00	8.00	8.00	8.00	8.67
Overall (Out of 100)	69.58	60.61	44.79	75.05	69.30	56.44	74.90	58.95

is its system load—with a page file utilisation of 30 MB, scan time of 13 minutes (three times more than that of the quickest program), and peak CPU utilisation of 88 per cent, it comes out looking like a sloth in a field of cheetahs.

On the bright side, the program does come a very close second in the virus detection test and has an excellent automatic update feature and interface.

Price: \$ 53.00 ■ **System requirements:** Windows 9x, Me, NT 4.0, 2000, XP, Pentium II processor or higher, 128 MB RAM, and 70 MB hard disk space. ■ **Web site:** www.f-secure.com ■ **Grade:** B-

McAfee VirusScan 7.0 Home Edition



Once the top dog in the anti-virus industry, McAfee has had a rough time since mid-2000. No version of VirusScan available at the time was compatible with Windows Me. Bad DAT file upgrades further reduced consumer confidence. Later versions had the unfortunate propensity to corrupt Outlook Express e-mail messages of its users, and were incompatible with Solitaire and FreeCell. Worse, certain versions had problems handling long file paths.

With version 7.0 though, all that is in the past. It turns out to be an all-rounder-providing good virus protection 4th in the virus scanning test, one-click updates, a great interface with oodles of aesthetic appeal, and best of all, a very competent personal firewall and an amazing visual utility to trace the route to any Internet destination. As the topper of our comparison, McAfee's back and it means business.

■ **Price:** \$ 49.99 ■ **System requirements:** Windows XP, 2000 Pro, Me, 98, 100 MHz processor, 32 MB RAM, 61 MB Hard disk space, Internet Explorer 4.01 SP2 ■ **Web site:** www.mcafee.com ■ **Grade:** A

Norton AntiVirus 2003

No mention can be made of McAfee without invoking its arch rival Norton AntiVirus (NAV). NAV is one program that viruses take very seriously. The current market leader, most people rely on it to protect them from the bad guys—and with good reason.

With its excellent user interface, extreme configurability, great schedules, and extra long access to updates, it makes for a formidable package. Uninstalling it might prove to be a bit of a pain though. It installs shared files in a separate directory, and refuses to uninstall them even if you don't have any other Symantec product installed. The same goes for its LiveUpdate and LiveReg utilities. After uninstalling the main program, you'll

need to manually go to the Add/Remove Programs, and uninstall both entries, with multiple reboots required. This is really an annoying step considering the lengths NAV goes to ensure user-friendliness. This is the reason it lost out in the overall score and finished fourth.

Price: \$ 49.95 ■ **System requirements:** 300 MHz processor, 128 MB RAM, 70 MB available hard disk space, Windows XP, 2000 Pro, Me, 98, Internet Explorer 5.0 ■ **Web site:** www.symantec.com ■ **Grade:** B+

Panda Antivirus Titanium

Panda Software was set up in 1990 in Spain. During its first years, products were sold exclusively as pre-installed versions with IBM or Tandon. In 1993, it began distributing products to the rest of the market. In 1998, Panda Software became Europe's leading anti-virus software developer, and is currently the fastest-growing anti-virus developer in the world.

It wouldn't be too wrong to say that Panda AntiVirus has literally crawled out of the bamboo work, to pose a serious threat to the dominance of the big players. It struts away with third place as far as raw virus detection goes. This comes as quite a surprise and makes this a program to reckon with. Unfortunately, it falls flat on its face in terms of configurability, giving you almost no options to choose. There's simply no depth in the configuration. It seems to have been designed from the ground up to be idiot-proof. Although that might be a blessing for most users, anyone even slightly experienced will find it an annoyance. In fact, this is the only factor that lets it lose out to its competition. From an extremely aesthetic interface to excellent automatic updates, it's got everything else neatly wrapped up.

■ **Price:** \$ 39.95 ■ **System requirements:** 90 MHz CPU, 32 MB RAM, 20 MB hard disk space, Windows XP, 2000 Pro, NT 4.0 workstation, Me, 98, 95 ■ **Web site:** www.pandasoftware.com ■ **Grade:** B

PC-cillin

Founded in 1988, Trend Micro headquartered in Tokyo, Japan, has grown into a company whose products are up there with the best. One product that seems to have it all neatly tied up, PC-cillin can apparently do no wrong. The facts say it all. It comes a close fifth in the virus detection tests. Fifth place out of eight contenders might not seem hot, but if you take a closer look at its scores, you'll find the scanning test was an extremely close battle.

So PC-cillin doesn't lose out too much, despite being in the bottom half. It has a user-friendly interface that provides a vast array of options, a bonus personal firewall, and great